INCH-POUND

A-A-51976A
15 October 1992
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51976
26 June 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

DIAPERS, INFANT

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a contoured absorbent disposable infant diaper.

Salient Characteristics:

The diaper shall be absorbent, disposable, and contoured, with elastic leg gathers and resealable, self-adherent, tab fasteners. The sizes shall be as follows:

Size 1 - Small, approximately 14 inches long by 10 inches wide, crotch width 7 inches, pad crotch width 4 inches, suitable for diapering infants weighing approximately 8 to 14 pounds.

Size 2 - Medium, approximately 17 inches long by 12 inches wide, crotch width 8 inches, pad crotch width 6 inches, suitable for diapering infants weighing approximately 16 to 24 pounds.

Size 3 - Large, approximately 19 inches long by 13 inches wide, crotch width of 9 inches, pad crotch width 7 inches, suitable for diapering infants weighing approximately 22 to 35 pounds.

AMSC/NA FSC 6532

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The diaper shall consist of the following components:

Facing material. The top sheet shall be a soft, porous, nonwoven, hydrophobic material consisting of plain or quilted polyester or polypropylene having superior dry and wet tear strength properties.

Inner layer (filler). The filler shall be cellulosic airfelt material made from fully bleached chemical pulp. An absorbent polymer dispersed throughout the core is optional.

Tissue sheets. The tissue sheets shall be made from chemical pulp (cellulose) and shall contain wet strength resin. The tissue sheets shall encase the filler and shall be at least as large as the filler. The chemical pulp used shall be free from stock spots, slime spots, oil, and dirt.

Polyethylene backing. The backing shall be fabricated of embossed or matte, low density, polyethylene.

Tab fasteners. The tab fasteners shall be polypropylene faced fastening tape with polypropylene based release tape. The tabs shall have suitable adhesive, allowing resealing of the tabs on the diaper, a minimum of one time.

Waistshields. The waistshields shall be fabricated of polyethylene or polypropylene and shall be located between the inner layer (topsheet) and the absorbent core. The waistshields shall extend from side to side of the diaper, and shall cover a minimum of one inch from the end of the diaper. As an alternate to the waistshields, the diaper shall have a elasticized waist, which contains one strip of elastomeric material laminated to a polypropylene sheet.

Elasticized leg gathers. Each diaper shall have at least one strip of elastomeric material on each side of the filling material. The strips shall be bonded to the polyethylene backing (outer layer). The strips shall be made of natural rubber, or other elastomeric material, and attached to the diaper to form a cuff around the infant's thigh.

Absorbent granular material (AGM). As an option the diapers may contain a suitable absorbent granular material. The dimensions and absorbent capacities of the diaper may vary accordingly.

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The components shall be assembled so that the nonwoven fabric facing is wrapped around the tissue-wadding-tissue sandwich at both ends and attached (by means of adhesive) to the bottom face of the bottom tissue along the ends of the diaper. The waterproof backing sheet shall extend beyond the pad ends and sides, be folded inwardly along the lengthwise edges and secured longitudinally to the facing with hot melt adhesive. The back of the assembled pad and the backing sheet shall also be bonded along the transverse ends of the pad near the edge of the pad. The fastening tape and release tapes shall be positioned on either side of the diaper at one end, on a line at right angles to the length of the diaper, appropriately located from the absorbent pad.

The finished diaper shall have the following minimum absorbent capacities (ml of urine) during normal use:

Absorbent capacity

Size	ML
Small	175
Medium	280
Large	340

The diaper shall be packaged in a plastic bag to prevent contamination from dirt, dust, and foreign particles. Each unit of issue shall contain four or more intermediate packages in accordance with commercial practice (such as cardboard or polyethylene containers).

Workmanship. The infant diaper shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance of impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One diaper of the size specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The

Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 4.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be two infant diapers.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for test purposes shall be two infant diapers.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Tests shall include, but shall not be limited to, the following:

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Absorptive capacity test for disposable diapers.

PREPARATION.

Open diaper so the fabric lining (topsheet), which lies next to the baby, is facing upward. Weigh absorptive material in pad and record. Cut a 3 inch x 4 inch pad from the diaper so that the 3 inch side is cut parallel to the length of the diaper. Make sure that the pad is cut from the fastening tape end of the diaper (if tapes are available), not from its middle, and that it is cut approximately equidistant from the side edges. Remove the fabric lining and plastic backing material from the pad. Any tissue which surrounds the inner absorbent materials should be left on the pad. Weigh the pad to the nearest 0.01 gram. Record as weight #1. Place the pad on a 3-1/2 inch x 4-1/2 inch glass plate. Weigh the pad and plate together and record the weight to the nearest 0.01 gram as weight #2. Place the pad and plate on a surface inclined at a 45 degree angle such that the 3 inch side of the pad runs from the top to the bottom of the 45 degree angled surface.

PROCEDURE.

Saturate the pad with water for one minute at a controlled rate of 500 plus or minus 25 ml/minute. (Note: Check water flow before starting test by running water into a beaker for exactly 6 seconds. If water volume is not 500 plus or minus 25 ml, adjust the flow and repeat procedure.) Remove excess water from the glass plate with an absorbent mopping material. It is important that the wet pad is never touched. If the mopping material touches the pad it may remove water and thus reduce the absorbency reading of the pad. After forty-five seconds, carefully remove the glass plate and pad from the angled surface. Holding the plate and pad horizontally, place on a piece of absorbent material to remove any water adhering to the bottom of the plate. Carefully place the pad and plate on a balance and weigh to the nearest 0.01 gram. Record as weight #3. Do not tip the pad and plate at any time because this may allow additional moisture to run off the sample.

CALCULATIONS. (All weight in grams)

$$\text{Absorption} = \frac{\text{Weight \#3 - Weight \#2}}{\text{Weight \#1}}$$

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Results represent the grams of water absorbed per gram of absorbing sample pad.

Total Absorptive Capacity of Pad	=	Total Weight of Absorptive Material in Pad x Absorption

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.
The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document.

6532-01-344-8497 - Small
6532-01-344-8495 - Medium
6532-01-344-8496 - Large

MILITARY INTERESTS:

CUSTODIANS:

Air Force - 03
Army - MD
Navy - MS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA - DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

FDA-MPQAS
USPHS
VA-OSS

Project Number: 6532-1225

Location: DIPRC13A.DOC

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